

However, you cannot start a Linux app from within the Chrome file manager. So, a file manager in the Linux environment is also useful. The Linux file browser will see only the files in the Linux virtual machine.

A user's files on Chrome OS are mapped to the Google Drive of the user. The one exception is the *Downloads* folder. So, the Linux environment can also access a user's files via Google Drive. It is expected that with folders in the *Downloads* directory, one may get the option to 'Share with Linux' soon. That may reduce the need to manually copy or move files between the two environments.

One habit I needed to form was the two finger tap for right-clicking, as that is the only way I can get a right-click on the Chromebook that I have.

Storage

The storage of 32GB is minimal by the standards of today, though it is more than enough for people accustomed to working with cloud storage, which I am not. On the Linux netbooks, using an external USB drive made it possible to work with considerable local disk storage when needed. Unfortunately, ChromeOS does not recognise ext4 or other Linux-specific filesystems on removable media. Hence, my external USB disk is not of much use with a Chromebook, even in the Linux environment.

However, Chrome OS has the option to access network file systems

using Samba or SSH, and that can be helpful if one needs more storage. The same options can be helpful from the Linux environment as well.

Overall, this is a very attractive option for a person not needing a powerful laptop. The reason for not recognising Linux based partitions on a USB drive is hard to understand. Now that Linux apps have become available, it would not be surprising if all the filesystems that can be mounted on USB drives on Linux are available on Chromebook as well. Meanwhile, I will just copy and carry the files I may need on a DOS formatted USB stick. **END** 

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